

THE DAILY BRIEF

SEPTEMBER 24, 2026

AI & TECH

Frontier model research, agent deployments, and the hardware behind them

Claude Discovers a Novel CRISPR-Like Enzyme System in 21 Hours. Anthropic announced that its flagship model autonomously identified a previously uncharacterized enzyme system — array-associated reverse transcriptases, or ART — found in bacteriophage DNA. Roughly 950 Claude agents, guided by researchers at Anthropic's newly-opened San Francisco biology lab, spent 21 hours sifting through massive DNA databases; the system resembles the repeat arrays that make CRISPR programmable, hinting at a new gene-editing mechanism. (Anthropic, Al Jazeera)

Meta Launches Camera-Free AI Glasses and a Tamagotchi-Like Wearable. Meta unveiled Muse, a camera-free AI agent device, alongside a Tamagotchi-style wearable built around it and a second swing at VR glasses positioned closer to an IMAX-style experience. The hardware push signals Meta's bet that ambient AI — not screens — will be the next interface layer. (TechCrunch)

Australia Probes OpenAI Over Government Health Website Hack. Australian authorities opened an investigation into whether OpenAI's scraping of a government health portal violated statutes — the first major regulatory test of whether public-sector data is fair game for foundation-model training pipelines. (TechCrunch)

New RSA Cryptanalysis Method Beats Prior Best Records. Researchers published a factorization technique that outperforms every published approach to date — a meaningful development for the post-quantum migration timeline, given RSA's continued use in legacy systems. (Ars Technica)

ArXiv Secures Multi-Year Funding to Remain Independent. The preprint server announced long-term commitments from institutional backers, ending months of uncertainty about its operating future and locking in its role as the de facto release channel for ML and physics research. (Ars Technica)

Snapdragon X2 Series Gains Linux Support Out of the Box. Qualcomm's next laptop-class ARM platform will ship with mainline Linux support, a milestone that finally makes ARM-on-Linux viable beyond Apple's ecosystem. (Ars Technica)

MARKETS & FINANCE

Equities, crypto, rates, and the macro picture

Bitcoin Drops Below \$84,000 as Hot PMI Data Stokes Rate-Hike Fears. The S&P; Global U.S. composite PMI for September rose to 58.4 — the strongest reading in more than five years — with services at 58.7 and manufacturing at 57. Stronger activity pushed the dollar and yields higher, and bitcoin slid to roughly \$83,793 on Binance, down 2.84% over 24 hours. CME FedWatch now prices a 75.3% chance of an October rate hike and a 58.6% chance of another in December. (Bloomberg via TradingView, Yahoo Finance)

Crypto Liquidations Top \$510 Million in 24 Hours as Leverage Flushes. Long positions accounted for \$363.8 million of the total, with \$135.8 million forced out in the single hour after the PMI release. Bitcoin's spot ETF inflows of \$1.7 billion over the prior two days suggest institutional buyers are still accumulating through the dip, creating a floor beneath the paper market. (TradingView, CoinGecko)

Fed Held at 3.75%-4.00% After September Hike, Warsh Signals More Tightening Ahead. Kevin Warsh's first FOMC as chair delivered a unanimous 25-basis-point hike on September 16, with the Summary of Economic Projections showing a median year-end funds rate of 4.1% and PCE inflation running at 3.7% this year before easing to 2.3% in 2027. The Fed now sees further increases "in coming months" to deliver price stability "on a timelier basis." (Federal Reserve, Reuters)

Stocks Slip as 10-Year Yield Hits 2007 High. On Wednesday, the Dow fell 0.7%, the S&P; 500 lost 0.8%, and the Nasdaq dropped 1.1% as long-dated Treasury yields surged on the rate-path repricing. Higher oil prices compounded the inflation concern: Brent crude traded near \$96 and WTI around \$90. (Yahoo Finance)

Solana Foundation Hires Binance and Polygon Vets to Drive Institutional Adoption. The Foundation added senior payments and institutional hires to push Solana deeper into bank-grade settlement rails, alongside IBM's Swift-linked tokenized-deposit pilot and a \$37 million Series A for HIFI's tokenized capital markets stack. (The Block)

Senate Democrats Demand Prediction-Market Hearings as GOP Meets Industry. A group of Democrats on the Senate Banking Committee called for open hearings on prediction-market regulation after closed-door GOP meetings with operators — a sign that political oversight is catching up to the Polymarket/Kalshi growth story. (The Block)

THE TAKEAWAY

The defining story of this Thursday is the bond market reasserting itself. The September PMI surprise at 58.4 — a five-year high — has forced a rapid repricing of the Fed path, and the 10-year yield's push toward 2007 highs is the kind of macro shock that punishes every risk asset at once. Bitcoin gave back 2.8%, equities sold off, and \$510 million of leveraged crypto positions got flushed in 24 hours. The interesting counter-signal: spot Bitcoin ETFs absorbed \$1.7 billion in net inflows over the prior two days. Paper traders are getting cleaned out, while real institutional money is quietly accumulating through the volatility. That divergence — combined with Warsh's "timelier" language at the September 16 FOMC — is the real story. The Fed has decided to err hawkish, and until the data cools, every dip in risk assets is also a setup for whoever has the dry powder to buy.

Generated by Marvin